

SETTING THE STAGE

There is little doubt that railways had a huge impact on the Indian landscape. The reasons for its introduction in the subcontinent were a combination of vested British interests in their colony as well as the perceived role of railways in driving a country on the route to modernization. Whatever the intentions might have been, the preliminary context for the introduction of railways in India can be explored in the state of transportation and communication after the end of the Mughal Empire.